My Career Plan

Gatsby Benchmarks • ASDAN • Personal Development Plan

Name: _____

Year Group: _____

Form / Tutor: _____

Academic Year: _____

Careers Adviser: _____

This is YOUR plan. Fill it in after every careers activity, review it with your tutor each term, and keep it updated throughout school.

How to use this plan

This booklet covers all 8 Gatsby Benchmarks — the national standard for careers guidance in schools. For each one there is a simple table of things to do, an ASDAN unit you can link it to, and a tick box so you can track your progress.

Each section has…	You should…
A short explanation of what the benchmark means	Tick each activity when you have done it and write the date
A table of activities to complete at school	Use the ASDAN column to collect evidence for your award
A reflection space to write what you learned	Review this with your tutor or careers adviser each term

GB1 – A Stable Careers Programme

Your school has a planned careers programme. You should know what careers support is available to you and take part in it throughout the year.

What I need to do	ASDAN unit	✓	Date / Notes
Attend careers week activities	CoPE: Planning for the Future	☐	Date: _____
Have a careers check-in with my form tutor each term	Personal Development short course	☐	Date: _____
Know who my Careers Leader/Adviser is	CoPE: Planning for the Future	☐	Date: _____
Complete my career plan in this PDP	CoPE: Planning for the Future	☐	Date: _____

What careers support has been most useful to me this year?

_____

_____

_____

GB2 – Learning About the Job Market

You should understand what jobs and careers are out there, what they pay, and how the job market is changing — including in your local area.

What I need to do	ASDAN unit	✓	Date / Notes
Research 3 careers that interest me	Research Skills / Using the Internet	☐	Date: _____
Find out which jobs are growing in my local area	Research Skills / Using the Internet	☐	Date: _____
Attend a sector spotlight assembly or talk	CoPE: Planning for the Future	☐	Date: _____
Set up a National Careers Service account (Y10+)	Research Skills unit	☐	Date: _____

✏ What did I find out about jobs in my area or in careers I am interested in?

_____

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_____

GB3 – Support for Me as an Individual

Everyone has different needs and goals. Your school should support you as an individual — whatever your background, interests, or additional needs.

What I need to do	ASDAN unit	✓	Date / Notes
Talk to my form tutor or careers adviser about my goals	Managing Emotions / Self-Review	☐	Date: _____
Complete my personal profile in this PDP	CoPE: Planning for the Future	☐	Date: _____
Attend 1:1 careers guidance interview	Action Planning unit	☐	Date: _____
Share any additional needs with my careers adviser	Working with Others unit	☐	Date: _____

What support do I need to reach my career goals?

_____

_____

_____

GB4 – Careers in My Subjects

The subjects you study at school link to real careers. Every subject can open doors — make sure you know how your lessons connect to the world of work.

What I need to do	ASDAN unit	✓	Date / Notes
Find out one career linked to each of my subjects	Vocational Tasters unit	☐	Date: _____
Complete a subject–career link activity in at least 2 lessons	Vocational Tasters unit	☐	Date: _____
Use the careers skills passport in my PDP	ASDAN Personal Development	☐	Date: _____
Ask a teacher how their subject links to jobs	Vocational Tasters unit	☐	Date: _____

✏ Which subject links most to the career I am interested in, and why?

_____

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GB5 – Meeting Employers

You should meet and talk with real employers at least twice a year. This helps you understand what work is really like and build your confidence.

What I need to do	ASDAN unit	✓	Date / Notes
Attend a careers fair or employer assembly	Enterprise / Young Enterprise	☐	Date: _____
Take part in a virtual employer Q&A or webinar	Enterprise unit	☐	Date: _____
Complete a mock interview with a real employer (Y11+)	Enterprise / Teamwork unit	☐	Date: _____
Reflect on each employer encounter in this PDP	CoPE: Planning for the Future	☐	Date: _____

✏ What did I learn from meeting an employer? What surprised me?

_____

_____

_____

GB6 – Experience of a Workplace

First-hand experience of a real workplace is one of the best things you can do for your career. This includes work experience, volunteering, and visits.

What I need to do	ASDAN unit	✓	Date / Notes
Complete a work experience placement (Y10)	Work Experience Prep & Review	☐	Date: _____
Write a reflection journal during/after placement	Work Experience Prep & Review	☐	Date: _____
Complete a volunteering or community project	Community Volunteering unit	☐	Date: _____
Attend a workplace visit (curriculum-linked)	Vocational Tasters unit	☐	Date: _____

✏ What skills did I use or develop during my work experience or volunteering?

_____

_____

_____

GB7 – Learning About College & University

There are many paths after school — A-Levels, T-Levels, apprenticeships, college and university. You should explore all the options open to you.

What I need to do	ASDAN unit	✓	Date / Notes
Attend a post-16 or post-18 options evening/assembly	Preparing for College unit	☐	Date: _____
Visit a college, sixth form or university (or virtually)	Higher Education Awareness unit	☐	Date: _____
Research at least 2 different post-16 pathways	Research Skills unit	☐	Date: _____
Complete my Pathways Planner in this PDP	CoPE: Planning for the Future	☐	Date: _____

What pathway am I most interested in after school, and why?

_____

_____

_____

GB8 – Talking to a Careers Adviser

You should have at least one personal careers guidance interview with a qualified adviser. This is your chance to talk about your goals and make a plan.

What I need to do	ASDAN unit	✓	Date / Notes
Attend my 1:1 careers guidance interview	Action Planning / Self-Review	☐	Date: _____
Set 3 SMART targets after my interview	Action Planning unit	☐	Date: _____
Review my targets with my tutor each term	Managing My Learning unit	☐	Date: _____
Update this PDP after every careers activity	CoPE: Planning for the Future	☐	Date: _____

What did my careers adviser help me realise? What is my next step?

_____

_____

_____

My SMART Career Targets

After each careers interview or review, write your targets here. A SMART target is Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant and Time-bound.

#	My Target & Steps	By When	Done?
1	Target: _____ Steps: _____	By: _____	☐ Done
2	Target: _____ Steps: _____	By: _____	☐ Done
3	Target: _____ Steps: _____	By: _____	☐ Done

My Employer Encounter Log

Record every time you meet or hear from an employer. You need at least 3 encounters across your time in school (GB5).

Date	Employer / Event	Industry / Sector	What I learned

Tutor / Adviser Review Record

To be completed by form tutor or careers adviser at each review meeting. Student keeps this as a record of their progress.

Date	Reviewed by	Progress notes / Next steps	Signature

ASDAN Award Summary

List any ASDAN units completed. Your ASDAN coordinator will countersign below.

ASDAN Unit Title	Award / Level	Date Completed	Coordinator Signature